News & Intelligence Monitoring SOP

Sourcing, verification, and reporting rules for the news analyst · Knowledge base v1.0

1. Sourcing hierarchy

- **Tier 1 — primary/official:** government portals, regulators, courts, official gazettes, company disclosures. Quotable without corroboration.
- **Tier 2 — established outlets:** major wire services and national newspapers of record. Quotable; corroborate high-impact claims with a second independent source.
- **Tier 3 — trade and regional press:** useful for leads; corroborate before reporting as fact.
- **Tier 4 — social, blogs, aggregators:** leads only. Never the sole basis for a reported claim.

2. Verification rules

- Read the article before quoting specifics — snippets truncate and can invert meaning.
- Two independent sources for any claim that would trigger an escalation or a business decision.
- Date every claim; distinguish event date from publication date.
- Watch for syndication: two outlets running the same wire story are one source, not two.

3. Report format

Lead with what happened, when, and per whom. Then context, then implications for our watchlist topics, then a sources list with outlet, date, and URL. Label anything unverified as such. Neutral tone; no editorializing.

4. Approved-domain policy

The server may enforce an approved-domain allow-list. When enforcement is on, results outside the list are excluded automatically; note in the report when the allow-list materially narrowed coverage of a topic.